

Stakeholder Engagement Plan

Community Renewable Energy Project

Illustrative project: Harbour Community Battery & Energy Hub

ILLUSTRATIVE SAMPLE

Purpose

This sample demonstrates the structure, thinking and level of detail that can be used for a client deliverable. The project is fictional and the content is illustrative. Every client plan is tailored to the brief, organisation, stakeholders, risks and operating environment.

1. Engagement context

A regional energy provider is investigating a community battery and small energy hub near an established residential and commercial area. The project is at an early design stage. Engagement is intended to identify local considerations, improve project design, build understanding and create a transparent record of stakeholder feedback before key approvals and delivery decisions.

2. Engagement objectives

- Identify people and organisations who may influence, be affected by, or have an interest in the project.
- Understand stakeholder needs, concerns, local knowledge and preferred ways of participating.
- Provide accessible information early enough for feedback to meaningfully inform decisions.
- Create transparent feedback loops so participants understand what was heard and what changed.
- Escalate emerging issues early and maintain respectful, documented relationships throughout the project.

3. Engagement principles

Principle	What it means in practice
Early	Engage before key decisions are locked in where stakeholder input can add value.
Relevant	Ask stakeholders about matters they can realistically influence.
Accessible	Use plain language, multiple participation options and suitable timing.
Transparent	Explain constraints, decision-making responsibilities and how feedback will be used.
Responsive	Record issues, close the loop and adjust the approach when new needs emerge.

4. Stakeholder map

Stakeholder group	Interest	Influence	Priority	Key consideration
Immediate neighbours	High	Medium	High	Amenity, safety, construction impacts
Nearby businesses	Medium	Medium	High	Access, continuity, local benefit
Local authority	High	High	High	Planning, transport, community outcomes
Community associations	High	Medium	High	Local values, information sharing
Emergency services	Medium	High	Medium	Site access and operational safety
Wider community	Medium	Low	Medium	Purpose, benefits, value for community
Project partners	High	High	High	Delivery, approvals, reputation

5. Engagement approach by priority

Priority	Approach	Typical methods
High	Proactive and two-way	Direct meetings, briefings, targeted updates, workshops, dedicated contact
Medium	Keep informed and invite input	Project updates, online feedback, drop-in sessions, targeted email
Low	Monitor and provide accessible information	Website, public updates, contact channel

6. Key engagement questions

- What local access, amenity or operational considerations should the project team understand?
- What information would stakeholders need to feel informed about the project?
- Which project impacts require the earliest or most direct communication?
- What opportunities or community benefits should be considered?
- How would stakeholders prefer to receive updates and provide feedback?

7. Engagement activity plan

Stage	Activity	Participants	Purpose
Discovery	Stakeholder interviews	Council, partners, key local groups	Validate issues and stakeholder map
Early design	Neighbour briefings	Immediate neighbours	Explain concept and gather local considerations
Early design	Business outreach	Nearby businesses	Understand access and operational needs
Consultation	Community drop-in + online feedback	Wider community	Share information and collect feedback
Refinement	Targeted follow-up	High-priority stakeholders	Test responses and close outstanding issues
Close-out	What-we-heard update	All participants	Show themes, responses and next steps

8. Issues, sensitivities and escalation

Issue / sensitivity	Management approach	Escalate when
Concern about proximity or amenity	Provide project-specific information and record individual concerns	Potential material design / approval impact
Misinformation circulating publicly	Correct factual errors consistently using approved project information	Reputational impact is increasing
Stakeholder expects influence outside scope	Clarify decision scope and document the constraint	Relationship is deteriorating
Repeated unresolved concern	Nominate owner, action and response date	Commitment cannot be met or risk increases

9. Feedback and reporting

Field	Example
Stakeholder	Immediate neighbour – northern boundary
Date / method	12 May – individual briefing
Theme	Construction access and operating hours
Feedback	Requests advance notice of high-noise activity and confirmation of driveway access.
Project response	Construction planning team to confirm access protocol and notification lead time.
Owner / due date	Project Manager – before detailed construction planning
Status	Open / monitoring

10. Success measures

- Priority stakeholders identified and contacted at the appropriate stage
- Engagement commitments completed and documented
- Feedback themes provided to decision-makers in a usable format
- Evidence of project changes or mitigations informed by stakeholder input
- Stakeholders receive a clear close-the-loop response
- Unresolved or high-risk issues have an accountable owner and escalation pathway

11. Deliverables

- Stakeholder register and prioritisation
- Engagement activity schedule
- Briefing / consultation materials
- Issues and commitments tracker
- Engagement summary / what-we-heard report
- Recommendations for ongoing engagement

SAMPLE NOTE

A live client version would be adapted to the project's governance, regulatory environment, organisation standards, stakeholder commitments, cultural context and any client-supplied engagement framework or template.